THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — SOCIAL_SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 3

Chapters 2–4: **Reshaping India's Political Map, The Rise of the Marathas, The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A student says 'Medieval' means the Middle Ages everywhere. A better reply is 1

(a) The term is borrowed and here denotes the 11th-17th centuries in India
(b) Correct
(c) It means ancient
(d) It means after 1857

2. Because forts were located on hills, the Mughal cavalry 1

(a) struggled to use its strength **(b)** needed no horses
(c) easily won **(d)** rode inside

3. Which was a long-term consequence of Plassey? 1

(a) Dutch rule
(b) Company moved from trade to political control
(c) French control
(d) Mughal revival

4. Why is a hundi like a modern cheque? 1

(a) It is land **(b)** It authorises payment to a named person
(c) It is coin **(d)** It is a tax

5. The expression 'Hindavi Swarajya' implies 1

(a) empire of Persians **(b)** theocracy
(c) foreign colony **(d)** a kingdom of the people of the land

6. In a famine, free kitchens and tax waivers would show 1

(a) exploitation **(b)** relief policy **(c)** profit **(d)** neglect

7. If a ruler with fewer men wins by guns against elephants and cavalry, the key factor is 1

(a) luck only **(b)** technology **(c)** religion **(d)** numbers

8. A ruler uses a Sanskrit seal and local language instead of Persian. This shows 1

(a) cultural assertion **(b)** trade
(c) foreign rule **(d)** no interest

9. The statement 'Railways were laid with Indian money but served British aims' suggests 1

(a) benefit to farmers **(b)** no effect
(c) exploitation **(d)** free gift

10. A document says merchants sent money by hundi to distant towns without moving coin. It implies [1]

(a) no towns **(b)** a trusted network of agents
(c) no trade **(d)** state ban on trade

11. The Treaty of Purandar can be seen as [1]

(a) end of Marathas **(b)** victory
(c) a tactical retreat **(d)** complete defeat

12. Rani Abbakka's use of fireballs shows [1]

(a) creative defence against a stronger fleet
(b) trade
(c) use of cannon only
(d) fear

13. If revenue is fixed on average produce measured over years, farmers gain [1]

(a) no certainty **(b)** protection from sudden demands
(c) higher taxes always **(d)** no protection

14. Shivaji's policy of sending officials to different posts at intervals ensures [1]

(a) corruption **(b)** accountability **(c)** friendship **(d)** power gain

15. What is the best evidence that India was a rich economy before colonisation? [1]

(a) Its large share of world GDP **(b)** Its poverty
(c) Its imports **(d)** Its famines

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. A fort is built on a hill with sea on one side. What advantages does it give? [2]

17. Why is the Doctrine of Lapse called unfair? [2]

18. Why did Lachit Borphukan's victory matter to Assam? [2]

19. How did chauth increase Maratha influence? [2]

20. How did the Resident control a ruler? [2]

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Assess the importance of Colachel in global history. [3]

22. A merchant uses hundis. Explain two advantages and a risk. [3]

23. Why might historians disagree about chauth? [3]

24. Examine how the British used religion and caste to divide Indians after 1857. [3]

OR

Case: A weaker army wins by using hills and forests. Name two such cases and the leaders. [3]

25. Evaluate the Maratha guerrilla tactics against a larger Mughal army. [3]

OR

Source: 'Indian in blood but English in taste.' Identify the author and the aim. [3]

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Evaluate the Subsidiary Alliance and the Doctrine of Lapse as tools of expansion. 5

OR

Assess the role of temples and monuments as sources of history and instruments of power. 5

27. How do sources such as the Adnyapatra and Modi records help us understand Maratha rule? 5

OR

Case study: A district sees railway lines built to the port while local markets decline. Analyse the colonial economy. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

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